

ICS Activation Checklist — Missing Person / Lost Guest

Printable checklist for a guest, team member, or child who is unaccounted for.

Time	Step	Actions	Lead / support	Confirmations
0–5 min	Step 1 — Confirm & alert	- Confirm the person is genuinely unaccounted for; gather last-seen time, location, description, clothing, medical condition, likely intentions. - Radio: "Code Missing — [name/description] — [last seen]." Alert IC and OC. If a child or anyone near water is missing, check all water features FIRST.	1st Responder / Reception / Guide	☐ Last-seen details gathered ☐ IC & OC alerted · water features checked first
5–15 min	Step 2 — Activate ICS & headcount	- IC activates the team; OC becomes Search Coordinator; LC readies vehicles, torches, radios; EC opens the Search Log. - Conduct a full headcount of guests and team; check the missing person's room/tent, common areas, vehicles, pool, perimeter; establish a Command Post.	IC / OC / EC	☐ Team activated, Search Log opened ☐ Headcount complete · Command Post established
15–30 min	Step 3 — Systematic search	- OC assigns sectors and launches a systematic search outward from the last-known point (concentric or grid pattern). - Searchers work in pairs, never alone, with radios; check water, vehicles, store rooms, walkways, perimeter fence; mark cleared areas.	OC / Searchers	☐ Sectors assigned · areas marked as cleared
30–60 min	Step 4 — Escalate	- If not located, IC notifies Park Rangers (KWS/TANAPA) and requests manpower, tracking, aircraft if available; notifies Head Office; considers neighbouring camps. - EC logs all calls; reassess and widen the search area, planning for terrain, water, and wildlife.	IC / EC / Park Authority	☐ Park Authority & HO notified ☐ Search area widened, call log kept
60 min+	Step 5 — Sustained / night search	- Move to managed search operations — defined shifts, a lighting plan, vehicle sweeps with spotlights, sound signals. - Night searches require an armed escort and no lone searchers due to wildlife risk; authorities lead the search once engaged.	IC / OC / LC / Authorities	☐ Shift plan & lighting in place ☐ No lone searchers · authorities leading if engaged
On location	Step 6 — Recovery & care	- On finding the person, Medic assesses and treats for exposure, dehydration, injury, or shock. - Evacuate per the Medical Emergencies checklist if required; account for and stand down searchers safely, reassure and reunite everyone.	Medic / OC / LC	☐ Person assessed & treated ☐ Searchers accounted for and stood down
Within 24 hrs	Step 7 — Debrief & reporting	- ERT debriefs within 2 hours of standing down. - EC and IC complete the Missing Person Search Log and Incident Report within 24 hours; review prevention (headcounts, escort procedure, briefings) and offer counselling if needed.	IC / EC / All Commanders	☐ Debrief done · Search Log & report completed ☐ Prevention reviewed